

SOCIAL MEDIA

THROUGH THE SHLICHUS LENS



🕒 COMPILED BY
MRS. ELKY RAITPORT
REVIEWED BY
RABBI YOSEF SHUSTERMAN,
DAYAN LEVI YITZCHAK RASKIN,
RABBI BARUCH HERTZ

TO DABBLE IN SOCIAL MEDIA for shlichus purposes may be enticing. After all, with nearly one-third of the world's population active on social media, it seems to be a most significant and effective way to reach Yidden everywhere. And it is.

We know there are benefits and we know there are risks. What best practices should we put into place so as to help ourselves stay in line?

While it is important for each person to consult with his or her rov and mashpia to determine what path to take, this spread presents a variety of points and perspectives culled from the input of shluchim and shluchos of many ages and from around the world.

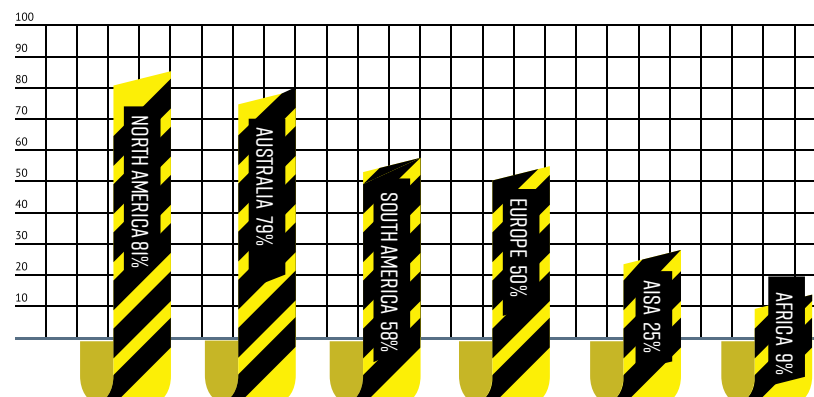
LET'S STAY LET'S STAY FOCUSED ON OUR UNIQUE OFFERINGS

By Rabbi Anchelle Perl
MINEOLA, NEW YORK

We are each on shlichus to our specific communities. Our job is to provide people with a connection to the Rebbe and to Torah and mitzvos with love. That's it. We're not a news digest site. Nor should we become conduits to simply repost and retweet. If we make a dinner, our invitation is going to be about our own community and mosad. Our posts should be the same. While I'm happy for my people to visit Chabad.org, AskMoses.com, or any of the other valuable websites, I generally try to stick with original posts—my community wants to communicate with *me*. I do occasionally share external links or copied content, but take care to add a personal comment to it. With social media platforms becoming increasingly impersonal, I find it all the more important to bring my personality into my every post.

I believe it is important for us

Who is active on social media?



to scrutinize our every post to determine whether or not it is in line with our mission. One of our community members is an avid gardener. She offered to lead a program, during which she would share gardening tips and lead attendees in planting their own tomatoes. Seeing this as an opportunity to speak about Basi Legani and brochos, we hosted the event. Baruch Hashem, 45 people showed up and it worked out beautifully. A few days later, the presenter sent me an email, which she requested I forward to the attendees, following up about their tomatoes. I explained to her that although I appreciated the gesture, Chabad of Mineola cannot become a gardening group and we are unable to send the email. Instead, when mentioning the program in my weekly email, I described the takeaway

message from our discussion on Basi Legani and brochos and also stuck in a line inquiring as to how people's plants were faring.

Similarly, we have to take care to stay away from politics. One of our regular shul-comers stayed away for a while because he got upset at the kiddush after a number of congregants sitting next to him voiced their opinions on the latest developments in the political world. He explained to me, "I come to shul to run away from politics!" Though I may be inviting elected officials to my programs and posing for photos with them, congratulating them—be it in person or online—would mean I'm taking sides. I don't believe we should be doing that. I don't recall hearing that the Rebbe endorsed or congratulated any public officials upon their election to office.

TRAVERSING SAFELY THROUGH THE NEW CHUTZAH

Rabbi Mendel Kaplan
THORNHILL, ONTARIO

For years, no matter what I did, there was a significant number of people in my community who I'd only meet three times a year in shul (or even less!). Nowadays, I am in touch with many of them much more frequently, thanks to social media.

On a typical day, there are 5-12 people sitting around the table at my class at 6:30 a.m. but there are hundreds of people watching it on Facebook Live, from far-flung places like Pakistan, Indonesia, Eastern Europe, South America, and Africa.

Most experts agree that the use of websites is on the decline—it certainly seems that way to me. I believe that today social media is the new chutzah and it is our job to spread the maayonos there, too. It is true that using social media is fraught with nisyonos and it is crucial for a person to check in with his or her mashpia frequently in this regard. But I believe that to ignore social media is to shirk our duty as shluchim.

Truth be told, it has not necessarily been an easy journey to navigate and there has been much trial and error. After significant criticism

from some of my fellow shluchim, and in consultation with my aseilcho rav, I now try to limit my posts to three primary categories: my shiurim (I host my shiurim through Facebook Live and post the professionally recorded versions from Chabad.org), Mivtza Tefillin-related (I've made it a habit to post photos of myself and others doing Mivtza Tefillin in unusual places), and Eretz Yisroel-related (I share my opinions on the goings-on so as to show people that shluchim care about Eretz Yisroel). I also realized that people today have very little patience to read much, so I revamped most of my weekly email bulletin on the schedule of events to short one-liners with catchy titles and use them as posts throughout the week as well.

Boruch Hashem, I have acquired a following of nearly 5,000 Facebook friends. I would estimate that nearly 50% of them live in my area. Of those, as many as 20% would probably never dream of stepping foot into my Chabad House. And suddenly, they're learning learning Torah and being inspired by tefillin selfies or articles I'm posting! Many have even messaged me that they've put on tefillin because of a photo I posted.

When determining whether or not to accept a friend request, I check out the person's wall. If the wall contains overtly non-tznius or anti-semitic indications or references, I do not accept the request. It is true that I don't personally know a very large number of the people who have friended or are following me, but because I don't use social media for personal things, who the people actually are is irrelevant to me.

Here is an example of the extraordinary reach of social media. A Chinese-looking man from California frequently watched my classes and sent deep questions.

His Facebook page indicated that he was part of a group that actively proselytizes Jews. He asked me for my phone number and I responded by writing, "send me yours and I'll call you when I have a moment." I called him one day while pumping gas. As soon as he answered the phone and I identified myself, I said, "I'll only answer your questions if you swear to me that you'll never try to proselytize a Jew again!" He responded that he could not do so, so I said I'd hang up the phone and never communicate with him again. Seeing that I was serious, he changed his mind and quickly swore as such, pleading with me not to hang up the phone. In conversation, I soon discovered that this man's mother was Jewish. Over time, I baruch Hashem was able to connect him with his local shliach, with whom he now visits regularly to put on tefillin.

This story is one of hundreds, if not more, of how social media interactions have led to real-life inroads with people who I would never have had the opportunity to reach otherwise. And I know many shluchim can claim the same, and even more. At the same time, I fully acknowledge that we can only allow ourselves to traverse the social media terrain if we arm ourselves with the siyagim and protections (most importantly, to avoid using these platforms for anything personal or to develop any kind of personal friendships with anyone on Facebook or Twitter) that are most essential for survival and success through this dangerous journey.

DON'T TRY THIS AT HOME

By Rabbi Binyomin Scheiman
DES PLAINES, ILLINOIS

As someone with 9,000 Twitter followers, 5,000 Facebook friends, and an active Instagram account, I'll be the first to tell you to avoid social media as much as possible. You can survive without social media. And if you really have to use it, you should do so only when absolutely necessary, with utmost caution, and the less the better.

The Frierdiker Rebbe referred to mashke as a *dovor hamo'us*. A person is not supposed to enjoy drinking it. It is only to be used when necessary to accomplish a specific goal but we have to know and remember that it is a despicable thing. Having a geshmak from the mashke is a sign that the person is in trouble. Social media is the same.

Social media is not for a Chassidishe bochur. Which means it is not for a shliach. Which means it is not really all that kosher. It is much better to be looking into a sefer than to be looking into Facebook. The nisyonos involved when using social media are tremendous.

I started using social media while fundraising for The Hinda Institute, a mosad I founded after my wife passed away that provides visitations and support to prison inmates and their families. I am not a blogger but found tweets of 140 characters to be something I could use to share inspirational thoughts as they crossed my mind throughout the day. I also began posting to Facebook after visiting prisons and doing other peulos. People liked what I

sent and I began to attract a large following. When I launched a crowdfunding campaign, I used social media to spread the word and did in fact bring in more donations as a result. But all this came with a very heavy price tag.

Ever since, I've done quite a lot of soul searching and have cut down my usage and interactions significantly. I've also cut down on my mashke intake quite a bit. The only reason I don't fully shut down my social media accounts is because I use them each year during my crowdfunding campaign. But I would if I could.

I am 60 years old and can sometimes get carried away with my social media usage. I can imagine younger people, especially those dealing with college students and teens, not having it any easier.

For those who feel they need to be on social media in order to communicate with their constituents, I'd strongly suggest avoiding Twitter. There's a lot of instability there and very little value. There's also plenty of instability on Facebook and a great need to be discerning with regard to interactions with others. But between the two, I'd suggest simply opening a mosad page on Facebook and posting all mosad-related updates and photos there. I don't see a need for a personal account. If you are using Facebook strictly for shlichus purposes, you don't need to attract or friend anyone other than your com-

munity members, for which purpose a mosad page will suffice. And as the rabbi and rebbetzin of your mosad, you are entitled to post your mazal tov news and mitvzoim photos on the mosad page. A personal account just stands to get you into trouble. I suggest ignoring all private messages sent to you by people you don't know personally—it is highly doubtful that they will lead to any good.

The creators of Facebook and Twitter and all the other platforms have spent millions of dollars researching on how to best draw people in, but the truth is that social media is nothing but a fantasy world that can be very addictive and take a person away from his or her real life despite the best of intentions.

Don't be wowed by my large number of followers and friends. I know less than one percent of these people personally. And while it is true that a person can never know the impact he or she may have on some unknown Jewish soul who has been following him or her on social media, the very real pitfalls and inevitable, unavoidable repercussions must be weighed very carefully in face of the virtual benefits.

PAVING THE WAY FOR OUR CHILDREN

By Rabbi Baruch Hertz
CHICAGO, ILLINOIS

As much as we see what we have accomplished on social media in terms of our shlichus, learning, and more, it is imperative that we examine the other side of the coin. I've seen the need for this both in the community as well as in the younger generation in which I am involved.

As much as we are trying to

inspire the whole world, we have to remember that our main shlichus is to reach ourselves and our families. At no price can we risk this part of our shlichus—even if it is at the expense of possibly helping others. As chassidim and as parents, we need to train the next generation about the need for precautions. The more we do so, the more it will become part of their culture and the easier time they will have.

The Rebbe wanted us to have an open dialogue with our rav and mashpia to help us know ourselves and put safeguards into place. In this way we can help prevent social media from infiltrating our lives in undesirable ways.

Installing a good filter and tracking system on each computer and mobile device can be a most helpful precaution. We can also safeguard ourselves by partnering with our spouse or friend and grant him or her access to all our social media accounts, creating transparency. Our children's presence, too, can help us determine whether or not something is appropriate—if we are not comfortable for our children to read the post, see the photo, or watch the clip, it is probably not all that holy for our own eyes, either.

Another point: Aside from the issue of devarim assurim, the attraction of social media is such that it can swallow up hours and hours of time without us even realizing. Despite all good intentions, this will inevitably divert us from properly fulfilling our shlichus, never mind being present for our families. Setting specific and limited times and locations for our social media usage and sharing them with a friend can help us stick to our commitments. And while many will claim that delegating social media tasks to a secretary will generate mediocre posts and responses, it is far better to have a poor internet presence than to have a poor presence in real life.

While the Rebbe frequently encouraged the use of technology for hafotzas hayahadus v'hafotzas hamaayonos, the Rebbe also often stated the obligation to taking precautions in these very areas. With the proper safeguards in place, we only stand to gain. We will enjoy a healthy family life, stronger relationships with our spouses and children, and success in fulfilling our shlichus.

TO FRIEND OR NOT TO FRIEND?

By M.S.

When setting up our Facebook account, y wife and I decided that we would not friend any fellow shluchim or members of Anash. We felt that it would help us stay focused on using Facebook as a shlichus tool and not as a means to keep up with family and friends. While some claim that they gain ideas by seeing what fellow shluchim post on Facebook, we felt that doing so could cause unnecessary comparison and jealousy. There are many Facebook Groups (not to mention the Shluchim Exchange and WhatsApp groups) that have been created for various demographics of shluchim and shluchos from which we could draw upon for ideas.

EVERYTHING FOR YOUR CHABAD HOUSE & BEYOND



THE
SHLUCHIM
SOURCE

~~\$1250~~ **\$1,100**

Pre-paid for the year
Use code TSS150*
*For new members only.

OR

\$150
MONTHLY

INCLUDES

Website Management • Email Management
Facebook events, album, posts, Photos Uploading • PR
Full setup/marketing for RCS, JLI and Torah Studies

PRE-PAID INCLUDES

Free flyers edits (from our stock library) • Priority Service
No rush fee • 10% discount on products

Upgrade! Now available, CMS and ChabadOne CRM management. Virtual assist members upgrade for just \$70/month or \$770/prepaid for the year.*

*Special introductory pricing. Subject to change.

Coming soon! CMH - Chabad Mailing House by The Shluchim Source
Your thank you letters and birthday/Yartzeit notifications printed and sent!
Writing services available too.

609-975-9075 TheShluchimSource.com

Info@theshluchimsource.com



WHAT TYPE OF ACCOUNT IS BEST?

Some shluchim maintain that is best to have two types of Facebook presences: a mosad page and a personal account. Others feel that opening a personal account should be avoided and that a mosad page is sufficient to meet any potential social media needs.

- **MOSAD PAGE:** Even if it only gathers dust, creating an “organization” page with your mosad’s contact information and descriptions such as synagogue, Jewish, kosher, etc., will enable people to find you when they are looking for you. Organization pages are hard to promote, since you can’t “friend” people, but using a personal page for your mosad is spammy and annoying for the people you are trying to reach. It is also in violation of Facebook’s terms of use, which means at one

¹ The answers to these questions are based on the input of more than 20 shluchim and shluchos as well as Compass’ rabbinical board. Please see the end of this spread for a list of names.

point or another Facebook can just delete the page and all the progress you’ve made on it.

- **PERSONAL ACCOUNT:** If opening a personal account, consider it to be your online pulpit. You can use it to keep up with the lives of your community members and connect with them as a rabbi online through posts that reflect your personal voice and style. While interactions on social media are generally more casual than other modes of communication, if you wouldn’t say something to someone in person, don’t say it on social media. If you wouldn’t hang up the photo in your Chabad House, don’t post it on social media.

MAY A PERSON “FRIEND” OR ACCEPT “FRIEND REQUESTS” FROM A PERSON OF THE OPPOSITE GENDER?

Friending someone of the opposite gender, whether or not you know him or her personally, may be considered a personal act and should be discussed with a rov and mashpia.

IS THERE ANY ISSUE WITH ME SHARING A JOINT ACCOUNT WITH MY SPOUSE?

While sharing a joint account with your spouse may seem to be the most ideal way to solve the issue of friending people of the opposite gender, it may in fact complicate matters. People may think they are having a private conversation with you, only to find out that they were interacting with your spouse, or vice versa. Additionally, a shliach’s male style of a post or response will often be different than that of his wife’s feminine voice and style, throwing off those reading the posts. It can create confusion when participating in a Facebook Group intended only for men or only for women. Fourthly, it is also

against Facebook’s terms of use and can see the account deleted.

Despite these issues, many shluchim, especially those dealing with teens and college students, have found that joint accounts are still the better route to take. They sign their own names after each post on their joint account to prevent misunderstandings as to who is saying what, as well as use email and text for private conversations.

Even so, for many shluchim, especially those primarily dealing with constituents over age 25, joint accounts are simply not a viable route to take. As such, many are careful to give their spouses their passwords and only correspond on social media in the presence of others. Even so, it would be advisable for shluchim to only friend males and shluchos to only friend females. Just as we have always managed to find ways to diplomatically avoid shaking hands with members of the opposite gender, we can direct those of the opposite gender to become Facebook friends with our spouses. As mentioned, each person should determine the path most suitable for him or her through consulting with both a rov and mashpia.

SHOULD I ACCEPT FRIEND REQUESTS FROM PEOPLE I DON’T PERSONALLY KNOW?

Many shluchim strongly recommend only accepting friend requests from people you know personally. One of the dangers of social media lies in its anonymity. There are all too many people who are bored, lonely, mentally or emotionally unstable, and even criminal, who pose as people they really are not and seek attention from anyone who will give it to them. Shluchim and shluchos, whose whole life is devoted toward unconditionally helping those in need, are likely to be the first to fall prey to these people, with no happy endings to the story.

Other shluchim are more open to

accepting friend requests from those they don’t know. Those shluchim each report doing some research before accepting such friend requests (see 65 for one example) and use their accounts solely to post shiurim, mitvzoim photos, and shlichus-related posts—without posting or corresponding about anything of personal nature whatsoever.

There is an option to enable the “follow” function on your personal page, allowing people who “friend request” you to see your public posts in their timelines without you accepting their requests. It is a good idea to familiarize yourself with Facebook’s privacy functions so you can customize the settings to fit your needs.

I DON’T HAVE TIME OR PATIENCE FOR FACEBOOK. CAN I GIVE IT OVER TO MY SECRETARY?

While having a secretary monitor your (personal) account and keep you updated on the happenings with people in your community can be efficient, it may not be a good idea because people may be trying to contact you through it (a good way to answer this is by asking yourself if your secretary has access to your email).

You may want to allow your secretary or a trusted mekurav access to just your mosad page so he or she can post as per your guidelines. Alternatively, you can set aside time once a week to write posts in advance, and then schedule them to post at specific times throughout the week. Many shluchim have recommended The Shluchim Source, whose virtual assist program is highly rated for its customer service, great turnaround, and quality work at economical pricing (see ad on previous page for details and special discount for *Compass* readers).

WHAT ARE THE PROS AND CONS OF CREATING A FACEBOOK GROUP?

A Facebook Group is a place where people can share information and communicate. If opening a Facebook Group for people in your community, it is important to set up the permissions carefully. Keeping the group open, where anyone can post, can make it more active and lively, but also opens the potential for all kinds of issues to arise and would require the attention of a moderator.

HOW DO I ENSURE THAT I AM SUFFICIENTLY PRESENT ON SOCIAL MEDIA WITHOUT SABOTAGING MY DAY?

Taking the time to consider and plan your social media usage as you would any other peulah is likely to help you manage your time and efforts wisely. Like every peulah, social media requires quality, consistency, and focus in order to succeed. Though some may say that a shliach who is not able to dedicate his time and energies to social media in this way is wasting his time, occasional posts and interactions can perhaps be likened to hosting a peulah of a more spontaneous nature. While these events are often not the stuff for photo ops, there are countless stories of neshamos who were touched when the shliach least expected it. Of course, it is crucial for each person to set his or her own limits on the amount of time spent on social media, as it can very easily eat up many hours and more. (See “How to Create a Social Media Strategy” in Volume 18 of *Compass Magazine* for more on this subject.)

14

BEST PRACTICES ON SOCIAL MEDIA

- Discuss your social media activities with your rov and mashpia and set guidelines for yourself.
- Set a scheduled timeslot for your social media work and stick to it.
- Make living a life of Yiddishkeit very much alive by living by example and sharing it with your community.
- Be cognizant of what you post, comment, share, and like. Consider tznius and people’s feelings. Most of all, consider who you represent.
- Be conscious about safety and security. Don’t post interior photos that can compromise security. Likewise, don’t post that you will be or are out of town. It is also not healthy to post too many details about your family, especially your children. Be aware—and wary—of settings on your social media platforms that share your location.
- Avoid politics (even if the politician is Jewish or a member of your community).
- Keep an eye out for old friends, who may now also be your Facebook friends, and may not consider that your community is watching them share old antics from your yeshiva days.
- Avoid arguing with people, especially people you don’t know well.
- Do not post photos of children without parental consent.
- Form your posts with complete words and sentences and proper grammar as you would when writing an official letter (personal responses or posts on platforms with a limited character count may be written shorthand).
- Think before you post. Everything you post is forever. Even if you delete a post, it can still be found and shared.

SHLUCHIM FARBRENG ABOUT SOCIAL MEDIA

Q: While misspellings, un-grammar, goofy photos, and wobbly amateur videos seem to be the language of social media, where “everything goes,” as shluchim we know that we represent someone greater than ourselves. But it can get a bit tricky. How do we determine what is appropriate or inappropriate for us to post, like, share, or retweet? If social media is meant to be used as a tool to connect with more Jews and draw them into our Chabad Houses and toward Yiddishkeit, don’t we need to post things that talk to our audience?

WHICH PARTY DO YOU BELONG TO?

Rabbi Levi Greenberg, EL PASO, TEXAS

In “Reshimas Hamaasar” (*Likkutei Dibburim* v. 4 p. 613) the Friediker Rebbe describes the events of 15 Sivan, 5687, when the GPU agents came to his apartment after midnight to arrest him.

“They began their search in the room of my daughters, Chayah Mussia and Sheine, and asked them: ‘What party do you belong to?’ ‘We belong to our father’s party,’ they replied; ‘we are non-partisan daugh-

ters of Israel. We are fond of the old ways of our Patriarch Israel, and detest the new aspirations.”

So, the next time you are asked which candidate you endorse, or for your positions on any given policy, or perhaps you feel the urge to engage in political slacktivism—to like, share, repost, retweet, or comment on any political content on social media—remember: “I belong to the Rebbe’s party....”

SUBSCRIBE THE REBBE TO YOUR FEED

Rabbi Rafi Rosenberg

NORTH MIAMI BEACH, FLORIDA

We should print the feeds on our Twitter and Facebook accounts and bring them to the Ohel on a regular basis—if not for real then at least as a mental exercise. The idea is that before we post we should imagine that the Rebbe is subscribed to our feed and ensure that he would be proud of our every post.

TRICK PHOTOGRAPHY?

Rabbi Avrohom Sternberg

NEW LONDON, CONNECTICUT

In today’s day and age, when the click of a button is all it takes to send a message to the entire world, it is easier than ever to identify with the Rambam’s statement that our every action has the power to tip the scales. Indeed, we can

no longer claim that what goes on in our respective mekomos hashlichus is a local affair.

Which is why it is so important that we take a few extra moments and scrutinize our photos before we post them. Camera lenses do funny things. They make people seem to be in closer proximity of each other than they actually are. They make photographed scenes look different than the reality that was. And when they’re posted online or on social media, they can create terrible stains—not only on the individuals in the photo but on their community and on Lubavitch.

Before you post, send your photos to a close friend who will be honest with you and tell you whether or not they belong publicized. As the camera companies work on increasing the intuitiveness, sensitivity, and focus of their lenses, let us continue working to refine our own intuitiveness, sensitivity, and focus.

HORA’OS REGARDING PHOTOS AND ILLUSTRATIONS IN PUBLICATIONS

Rabbi Dr. Dovid Sholom Pape

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK

We used to give the Rebbe a draft of the cover of each issue of *The Moshiah Times* for review before print. Once, pointing to a sketch of a boy, the Rebbe replied that the tzitzis he was wearing should be clearly visible—preferably on both sides. With regard to a sketch that included both a boy and a girl, the Rebbe wrote that the illustration should indeed include both the boy and the girl, but that the girl must be “*b’keren acheres*,” in the opposite corner. I understood this to mean that there must be a

AFTER ALL IS SAID AND DONE, THERE’S NOTHING LIKE PICKING UP A PHONE OR RINGING A DOORBELL TO MAKE A REAL, PERSONAL CONNECTION.

clear distinction between boys and girls in all illustrations and photos. Ever since, we have tried to be careful to always place a vase, a table, a tree, or something else between the boys and girls.

A shliach once prepared a Neshek brochure and presented it to the Rebbe. The brochure featured a photo of a woman who was modestly dressed but whose top shirt button was open. The Rebbe asked, “Who is responsible for this?” Needless to say, the thousands of brochures that had been printed were immediately disposed of.

OUR CRITERIA

Rabbi Moshe Feller

S. PAUL, MINNESOTA

A shliach once presented me with the following quandary: one of his dinner’s honorees had attended the dinner dressed immodestly and he was unsure as to whether or how he could post photos of his dinner with that being the case. I told him that I didn’t think he should publish the immodest photos. Our criteria must be that of the Shulchan Aruch. Pirkei Avos states, “umekarvan latorah.” We cannot ingratiate ourselves with our constituency, we have to bring them to us and not the reverse.

NOT JUST AN INVITATION

Mrs. Mindelle Feller, S. Paul, Minnesota

The Rebbe treated every dot and dash of printed publications with utmost significance, raising our own awareness as to the far-reaching impact of even the “minor” details that may often be overlooked.

S. Paul, Minnesota hosted the N’shei Ubnos Chabad convention in 5741. After preparing the invitation, we sent it to the Rebbe for his review. The Rebbe returned the invitation with a question mark near the time we had listed for candle lighting that Shabbos. I was surprised and confused because I had taken particular care to ensure that the listed time was correct—I had called two radio stations, as well as asked two newspapers and they had each provided the same time. I had even contacted the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) in Washington, D.C. to confirm the time with them and they had given the same time too. I asked Rabbi Krinsky for some insight as to the meaning of the question mark. Rabbi Krinsky responded that the Rebbe becomes upset when the incorrect candle lighting time is listed but that if I was sure the time was correctly listed, I could leave it at that.



MAKE SURE YOUR MOSAD LISTINGS ON GOOGLE MAPS, YELP, FOURSQUARE, AND FACEBOOK ARE CURRENT SO PEOPLE CAN FIND YOU.

I was not satisfied with this response and probed deeper. I soon realized that the invitation was not only being sent to women in our city, but to women throughout the United States. The candle lighting time would thus be incorrect for those women, prompting me to add the words “Times are for Twin Cities, Minnesota” nearby.

The Rebbe had also commented with “!?!?” near text stating that “men are invited” for the melave malka segment of the convention. While I had simply reused the text that had been printed on the invitation of the year prior, I soon realized the issue with that text and changed it to “Husbands are invited.” 📌

הכבוד הנדרש לתמונת רבותינו נשיאינו

הוראת הרבי למנהל מוסד חב"ד די שהדפיס עמוד ובו תמונת כ"ק אדמו"ר מהוריי"צ, לצד תמונת נשים שסייעו למוסד

באם רוצה לתת אות הצטיינות למרת פ' [לונית] ופ' תחיינה - האומנם ברשותו [לתת אות הצטיינות] זו ע"י הדפסת תמונה שלהן דוקא ביחד עם תמונת כ"ק מו"ח אדמו"ר? כמה ענינים מבהילים כבר ראיתי - אבל מודה אני אשר ענין זה מהראשנים "במעלה" ביניהם.

בודאי תומ"י יבער מן העולם עמוד זה. כיון שאין ביכולתי להשתתף באחריות הנהגה שבשביל "publicity" [=פרסום] שטעלט'ן זיך ניט אפ [=לא עוצרים] אפילו מדברים כהנ"ל - יסיר את שמי מכל הסטיישנערי [=נייר המכתבים], חוברות וכו'.

באם לעצתי ישמע - יקבל עליו תענית באחד ימים הקרובים, יסע על הציון הק' ויבקש מחילה סליחה וכפרה - על הנ"ל, ויקבע לימוד במאמרי כ"ק מו"ח אדמו"ר בכל יום - עד ר"ה הבע"ל (כמובן בל"נ).

באם מי שהוא השתתף אתו בפעולה האמורה - מובן שגם אליו שייך כ"ז.

(תשורת סימפסון-סורדיק, ר"ח כסלו תשע"ז)

In addition to our gratitude to the 10 shluchim and shluchos whose names have been listed as contributors to the various essays in this spread, *Compass* staff thanks the following people, as well as those who prefer to remain anonymous, for their valuable assistance in its preparation and editing.

Rabbi Hershey Novack, S. Louis, Missouri
Rabbi Motti Seligson, New York, New York
Rabbi Ari Shishler, Sandton, South Africa
Rabbi Zalman Tiechtel, Lawrence, Kansas
Rabbi Eliezer Zalmanov, Munster, Indiana
Mrs. Fraidy Brook, Waukesha, Wisconsin
Mrs. Ella Potash, Redwood City, California

DON'T FORGET TO PROMOTE YOUR SOCIAL MEDIA AND WEB PRESENCE WITH A GOOD OLE FASHIONED SNAIL-MAIL POSTCARD.